

Ch 4: Political Parties

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

Q1. What is a political party? Name its three components.

Q2. Who is a partisan? What is partisanship? *(PYQ 2016)*

Q3. Why do political parties involve partisanship? *(PYQ 2016)*

Q4. What is a manifesto? What role does it play during elections?

Q5. What is a one-party system? Give one example.

Q6. What is a two-party system? Give one example.

Q7. What is a multi-party system? Why does India have a multi-party system?

Q8. What is an alliance or front in a multi-party system? Give one example from India.

Q9. What is a recognised political party? What facilities does it get from the Election Commission? *(PYQ Term-1 2021-22)*

Q10. What is a national political party? What are the criteria for being recognised as a national party?

Q11. What is a state party? What are the criteria for recognition as a state party?

Q12. Name any two national political parties of India currently.

Q13. Name any two state political parties of India with the states they are mainly active in.

Q14. Which national party gets its inspiration from India's ancient culture and values?

Q15. What is the ideology of the Indian National Congress?
(PYQ)

Q16. Name one political party of India that grew out of a movement. (PYQ 2017)

Q17. How are candidates for elections chosen in the USA? How does this differ from India? (PYQ)

Q18. What is the main challenge of a dynastic succession in political parties?

Q19. What is money and muscle power in politics? How does it affect democracy?

Q20. What is a 'political reform' in the context of parties? Give one example.

Q21. What is the Right to Information Act? How does it help reduce corruption in political parties?

Q22. What are the three challenges or shortcomings of political parties mentioned in the chapter?

Q23. Name any two women leaders of national political parties in India.

Q24. What is the Election Commission? What power does it have over political parties?

Q25. What is an opposition party? What is its role in a democracy?

Q26. What facility does the Election Commission give to a recognised political party? (PYQ Term-1 2021-22)

Q27. What does a political party do when it wins elections? What does it do when it loses?

Q28. Name the political party which gets support mainly from the upper castes and the trading community.

Q29. What is meant by 'inner-party democracy'? Why is it important?

Q30. What is a coalition government? Give one example from India.

Q31. What percentage of votes must a party get in Lok Sabha elections to be recognised as a national party?

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

- Q1. Explain any three functions of political parties in a democracy. (PYQ — most repeated)**
- Q2. What are the three challenges or shortcomings of political parties? Explain each briefly. (PYQ)**
- Q3. Explain three ways in which political parties can be reformed to make them more democratic.**
- Q4. Distinguish between a national party and a state party. Give two examples of each.**
- Q5. Distinguish between a one-party system, two-party system, and multi-party system. Give one example of each.**
- Q6. Why do we need political parties? Explain three reasons. (PYQ)**
- Q7. How do political parties shape public opinion? Explain three ways.**
- Q8. Explain why India has a multi-party system instead of a two-party system. Give three reasons.**
- Q9. Explain three ways in which political parties are necessary for democracy.**
- Q10. Explain how political parties can be reformed. Mention three legal and constitutional measures already taken.**

Q11. Explain any three problems or challenges faced by political parties in India today.

Q12. Explain three ways in which money and muscle power have corrupted democratic politics in India.

Q13. Explain the problem of dynastic succession in Indian political parties. How does it affect inner-party democracy?

Q14. Explain three ways in which citizens and civil society can hold political parties accountable.

Q15. Explain the significance of a multiparty system for a diverse country like India. Give three reasons.

Q16. Explain the role of the opposition party in a democracy. Why is it called the 'watchdog' of democracy?

Q17. Explain three functions of political parties related to elections and governance.

Q18. How do political parties link the government and the people? Explain three specific ways.

Q19. Explain three characteristics of a political party that distinguish it from a pressure group.

Q20. Describe the ideology and social base of any two national political parties of India.

Q21. Explain how political parties perform the function of forming and running the government. Give examples from India.

Q22. Explain three ways in which political parties have failed to meet people's expectations in India.

Q23. Explain the role of regional or state parties in India's democracy. Why have they grown in importance?

Q24. Explain the Electoral Reforms introduced in India since the 1990s to improve the functioning of political parties.

Q25. Explain how the affidavit system and Right to Information have helped voters make better choices. Give three points.

Q26. Explain three ways in which political parties mobilise voters and build support among the electorate.

Q27. Explain three measures that the government has taken to prevent the misuse of money during elections.

Q28. Explain why lack of internal democracy is considered the most serious challenge for political parties. Give three points.

Q29. Explain how coalition politics has changed the nature of governance in India since the 1990s. Give three examples.

Q30. Explain three ways in which women are underrepresented in Indian political parties and what can be done to improve their participation.

Q31. Explain the difference between a national party and a regional party in terms of their social base, ideology, and geographic reach. Give examples.

Q32. How has the rise of regional parties weakened the dominance of national parties in India? Explain three specific examples.

Q33. Explain three reasons why political parties are called the most visible institution of democracy.

Q34. Explain three functions of the Election Commission of India in relation to political parties.

Q35. Explain how laws requiring candidates to declare criminal cases and assets have helped improve transparency in Indian elections.

Q36. Explain how political parties in India have tried to broaden their social base by including women, minorities, and backward classes. Give three examples.

Q37. Explain why candidates with criminal backgrounds continue to win elections in India despite public awareness. Give three reasons.

Q38. Explain three ways in which political parties can be made more accountable through changes in the legal framework.

Q39. Describe the growth of regional parties in India since the 1990s. Why have voters increasingly preferred regional over national parties in many states?

Q40. Explain three differences between alliance politics and single-party majority governments in India.

Q41. Explain how political parties play a role in forming public opinion on key issues. Give three specific examples.

Q42. Explain any three steps that ordinary citizens can take to reform political parties and improve democracy.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. Explain the functions of political parties in a democracy. Why do we need political parties? Give five points. (PYQ — *most repeated*)

Q2. What are the challenges faced by political parties in India? Explain five shortcomings and suggest measures to reform them. (PYQ — *frequently asked*)

Q3. Distinguish between one-party, two-party, and multi-party systems with examples. Why is a multi-party system considered most suitable for India?

Q4. Explain why political parties are considered the most visible institution of a democracy. What functions do they perform? Give five examples.

Q5. Explain the various ways in which political parties can be reformed to make them more democratic and accountable. Give five specific measures — both those already taken and those that should be taken.

Q6. Describe any two national political parties of India. For each, explain their origin, ideology, social base, and role in Indian politics.

Q7. Explain how regional political parties have grown in India since the 1990s. What has caused their rise and what impact have they had on national politics?

Q8. "Political parties link the government and the people." Justify this statement with five specific examples of how parties perform this linking function.

Q9. Explain the problem of dynastic politics in India. How does it affect inner-party democracy? What reforms can address this? Give five points.

Q10. Explain how money and muscle power have distorted democratic elections in India. Give five examples and suggest five measures to control this problem.

Q11. Compare the multi-party system in India with the two-party system in the USA across five parameters — number of parties, coalition politics, party discipline, social representation, and government stability.

Q12. Explain how political parties are necessary for democracy to function. What would happen to democracy if political parties did not exist?

Q13. Explain the role of opposition parties in a democracy. How do they hold the government accountable? Give five specific examples from India.

Q14. Explain why the lack of internal democracy is the most serious challenge for political parties. How does it lead to dynastic politics, criminalisation, and lack of accountability?

Q15. "Citizens can reform political parties from outside." Explain five ways in which citizens, civil society, media, and movements can pressure parties to reform.

Q16. Explain the legal and constitutional reforms introduced in India to make elections and political parties more transparent. Give five specific reforms and their impact.

Q17. Explain how coalition governments have changed the nature of governance in India since 1989. What are the advantages and disadvantages of coalition politics? Give five points each.

Q18. Explain the social base, ideology, and electoral performance of any three national political parties in India. How do they differ in their approach to governance?

Q19. "Political parties are essential but deeply flawed institutions of democracy." Justify this statement with five points showing both their necessity and their shortcomings.

Q20. Explain how the Election Commission of India has tried to reform the functioning of political parties through various regulations and rules. Give five specific examples.

Q21. Explain the role of political parties in India's federal system. How do national and regional parties interact in coalition governments at the Centre?

Q22. Describe the evolution of India's multi-party system from independence to the present day. How has the party system changed over seven decades?

Q23. Explain the problem of criminalisation of politics in India. Why do parties give tickets to candidates with criminal records? What reforms are needed?

Q24. "Women are severely underrepresented in Indian political parties and legislatures." Explain this with five points and suggest measures to improve women's political representation.

Q25. Explain how political parties perform the dual function of government formation and representation of social groups. Give five examples showing how parties try to represent different sections of Indian society.